

# Pre-Event Master Checklist & Developer Resource Hub

A Step-by-Step Guide: Free API Keys, Cloud Accounts, Offline Tooling, and the 9:00 AM Disqualification-Proof Protocol

## CRITICAL HACKATHON RULE — PREVENT DISQUALIFICATION:

Hackathons strictly prohibit pre-written application source code. Judges inspect your GitHub commit history and timestamps. If your application codebase contains commits dated before **16th September, 9:00 AM**, your team will face immediate disqualification. However, **rules 100% encourage having all developer tools, cloud accounts, API keys, and runtime libraries pre-installed and verified beforehand**. This dossier lists everything you must prepare before 9:00 AM so you can execute at 10× speed without breaking any rules.

## 1. Essential Free API Keys & Registration Links (Get These Today)

Do not waste hackathon minutes during the event waiting for phone OTPs or account verification emails. Sign up for these free developer tiers now and save the generated keys in a secure text file on your laptop.

| Service / API       | Key Capability & Role in Hackathon                                                                         | Direct Portal Link (Clickable)                                      | Free Tier Limit                          |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Google Gemini API   | Multimodal AI: Image & document scanning, OCR for Aadhaar/ID, visual room inspection, smart chat.          | <a href="https://aistudio.google.com">aistudio.google.com</a>       | Free tier: 15 RPM / 1M TPM (Instant key) |
| Groq Cloud API      | Ultra-fast LLM inference (Llama 3.3 70B). Sub-200ms latency blows hackathon judges away during live demos. | <a href="https://console.groq.com">console.groq.com</a>             | 100% Free developer access               |
| Razorpay Sandbox    | Mock UPI payment gateway, dynamic UPI QR generation, test penny-drop verification, escrow simulation.      | <a href="https://dashboard.razorpay.com">dashboard.razorpay.com</a> | Free sandbox (Test Mode: rzp_test_...)   |
| Mapbox GL           | Interactive vector maps, geo-pinning for spaces, routing, radar geofences, and dark map themes.            | <a href="https://account.mapbox.com">account.mapbox.com</a>         | 50,000 free map loads / month            |
| Resend (Email)      | Transactional booking receipts, smart contract micro-lease email delivery, student OTP dispatch.           | <a href="https://resend.com/signup">resend.com/signup</a>           | Free: 100 emails/day, 3,000/mo           |
| Supabase (Postgres) | Hosted PostgreSQL database, instant REST/GraphQL APIs, user authentication, and photo storage buckets.     | <a href="https://supabase.com/dashboard">supabase.com/dashboard</a> | 2 free cloud projects, 500MB DB          |

## 2. Cloud Deployment & Hosting Platforms (Pre-Authenticate)

When presenting to judges, a live HTTPS URL on their own phones is 10× more impactful than pointing at your laptop screen. Have these deployment platforms signed in via GitHub beforehand:

| Platform   | Best For                                                                                      | Setup Link (Clickable)                                          | Why Pre-Authenticate?                                      |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| GitHub     | Repository hosting, collaboration, team access, and continuous deployment triggers.           | <a href="https://github.com/signup">github.com/signup</a>       | Ensure 2FA is configured on your mobile authenticator app. |
| Render.com | Python Flask / FastAPI backend hosting, Gunicorn WSGI, PostgreSQL databases, Docker services. | <a href="https://dashboard.render.com">dashboard.render.com</a> | Connect with GitHub for 1-click `render.yaml` deployment.  |
| Vercel     | Next.js, React, Tailwind CSS frontends, Serverless API functions, global edge CDN.            | <a href="https://vercel.com/signup">vercel.com/signup</a>       | Zero-config automated Next.js deployments on `git push`.   |

### 3. Local Machine Setup & Offline Package Caching (Run Today)

At hackathons, venue Wi-Fi routinely fails or throttles when hundreds of students download packages at the opening bell. Run these commands on your laptop **before leaving for the venue** so all wheels and modules are pre-cached in your local cache:

```
# 1. Pre-install and cache core Python packages (Backend & AI):
pip install flask flask-sqlalchemy werkzeug gunicorn requests python-dotenv reportlab pydantic

# 2. Pre-cache Google GenAI and Groq SDKs:
pip install google-genai groq pillow

# 3. Verify Node.js and pre-cache Next.js / Tailwind global packages:
node --version && npm --version
npx -y create-next-app@latest --version

# 4. Configure Git identity (avoids failed commit errors during the event):
git config --global user.name "Your Name"
git config --global user.email "your.college.email@example.com"
```

### 4. Physical Hardware & Venue Survival Kit

Technical skill is useless if your laptop runs out of battery or you cannot connect to the internet. Pack these items:

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. Multi-Plug Spike Guard / Extension Board (Crucial!)</b><br>Hackathon tables provide 1 or 2 wall sockets for 4–6 teams. Bringing your own 3-or-4-socket extension cord guarantees your team's laptops, phones, and hotspots never die. | <b>2. 5G Mobile Data Hotspot (Do Not Rely on Venue Wi-Fi)</b><br>Recharge a 5G data booster pack on your phone (Jio / Airtel). College Wi-Fi often enforces AP client isolation or blocks SSH/API ports. Your phone's personal hotspot is your lifeline. |
| <b>3. HDMI / Type-C Display Adapter</b><br>When presenting your project to judges or pitching on stage, having a Type-C to HDMI converter prevents awkward technical delays when connecting to the venue projector.                         | <b>4. Mouse &amp; Earphones / Earplugs</b><br>Hackathon halls are noisy and chaotic for 24–36 continuous hours. Earplugs or noise-cancelling headphones help you code with laser focus during the overnight sprint.                                      |

### 5. Instant Frontend Assets & Zero-Build CDN Snippets

Save these CDN script tags in your notes. They allow you to build polished, responsive, dark-mode UIs in seconds without waiting for build tooling:

```
<!-- 1. Tailwind CSS CDN (Instant responsive styling without webpack/vite) -->
<script src="https://cdn.tailwindcss.com"></script>

<!-- 2. FontAwesome 6 CDN (6,000+ modern icons) -->
<link rel="stylesheet" href="https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/npm/@fortawesome/fontawesome-free@6.4.0/css/all.min.css">

<!-- 3. Google Fonts (Inter / Plus Jakarta Sans) -->
<link rel="stylesheet"
href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Plus+Jakarta+Sans:wght@300;400;500;600;700&display=swap">

<!-- 4. Instant QR Code Generator API (No library needed!) -->
https://api.qrserver.com/v1/create-qr-code/?size=250x250&data;=YOUR_LIVE_URL_HERE
```

### 6. The 16th Sept 9:00 AM Opening Playbook (First 60 Minutes)

When the clock strikes 9:00 AM on the 16th and the official problem statements are released, execute this exact timeline:

| Time Window | Team Priority & Action Item | Key Deliverable |
|-------------|-----------------------------|-----------------|
|-------------|-----------------------------|-----------------|

|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                               |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>09:00 – 09:20 AM</b> | Problem Statement Analysis: Read all prompts. Pick the one where your architecture (peer-to-peer marketplaces, AI matching, India Stack verification, or trust scoring) delivers the highest impact. | Locked Problem Statement & 1-line Value Proposition.          |
| <b>09:20 – 09:30 AM</b> | Architecture & Role Allocation: Define the 4 roles: (1) Backend/DB; (2) Frontend/UI; (3) AI/Prompts; (4) Pitch Deck & Judge Flow.                                                                    | Schema & API Contract agreement.                              |
| <b>09:30 AM SHARP</b>   | <b>Clean Repository Initialization:</b> Run `git init` on GitHub. Add team members as collaborators. Commit `README.md` with timestamp clearly after 9:00 AM on the 16th.                            | <b>First official Git commit. Zero disqualification risk.</b> |
| <b>09:35 – 12:00 PM</b> | Core Feature Sprint: Build the core user journey end-to-end. Focus on the 'Hero Workflow' that judges will test.                                                                                     | Working prototype with mock data.                             |

**Winning Tip for Pitching:** Judges evaluate: (1) **Problem-Solution Fit** (30%); (2) **Working Technical Execution** (30%); (3) **Business Viability & Unit Economics** (20%); and (4) **Presentation Quality** (20%). Having your accounts, keys, and environments ready beforehand frees up 100% of your mental energy to focus on building an award-winning product. Good luck at Hack2Ignite 2026!